

Giovanna Ferrari

GRADUATE STUDENT IN MARRIAGE, COUPLE & FAMILY COUNSELING

(310) 923-1194 · giovanna.design76@gmail.com · giovannaferrariart.com · Pittsburgh, PA

ABOUT ME

Graduate student in Marriage, Couple and Family Counseling at Duquesne University, practicing artist, and former product designer with a growing focus on art activities and expressive approaches to emotional well-being. I enjoy creating opportunities for people to connect, communicate, and express themselves through creativity, and have experience facilitating art workshops and volunteering with art activities for patients in senior healthcare communities. I bring a thoughtful, compassionate, and collaborative approach, with strengths in active listening, organization, facilitation, and creating welcoming spaces where people feel comfortable participating and expressing themselves.

EDUCATION

M.S., Marriage, Couple & Family Counseling · Duquesne University In Progress
CACREP-accredited program · Counselor Education & School Psychology

Laurea in Public Relations · IULM University, Italy 2001

ART & CREATIVE PRACTICE

Artist & Creative Practitioner · *Independent Artist · Pittsburgh, PA* 2020–Present

- Maintain an independent studio practice focused on contemporary painting and expressive visual exploration.
- Develop and exhibit original artwork through independent and community-based exhibitions.
- Manage creative projects from concept development through production, presentation, communication, and promotion.
- Use painting and visual expression to explore inner experiences, emotions, and the stories we carry with us.
- Participate in the Pittsburgh arts community through exhibitions and creative programming.

ART ACTIVITY & COMMUNITY VOLUNTEERING

Art Activity Volunteer · *Jewish Association on Aging · Pittsburgh, PA* Summer 2024

- Provided art classes and art-based activities for individuals living with dementia.
- Used creative engagement to encourage self-expression, connection, and participation.
- Supported participants with patience, empathy, and individualized attention.
- Observed how creative activities can facilitate communication and emotional expression when verbal communication is difficult.

PRODUCT DESIGN

18 years in product design (2008–2026), managing projects across technology, healthcare, financial services, education, and consumer products.

Companies include ThousandEyes (Cisco), NewRez, Anthem Find Care, Uber, Petuum, PNC Bank / Virtusa, and education-focused consulting.

STRENGTHS & INTERESTS

Strengths: Interpersonal communication · Active listening · Facilitation · Organization · Collaborative work · One-on-one support · Public engagement · Project coordination

Interests: Art activities · Expressive modalities · Dementia care · Emotional expression · Community-based arts